

ONE MORE

TEXT: Luke 15:1-7 *“Now the tax collectors and “sinners” were all gathering around to hear him. But the Pharisees and the teachers of the law muttered, “This man welcomes sinners and eats with them.” Then Jesus told them this parable: “Suppose one of you has a hundred sheep and loses one of them. Does he not leave the ninety-nine in the open country and go after the lost sheep until he finds it? And when he finds it, he joyfully puts it on his shoulders and goes home. Then he calls his friends and neighbors together and says, ‘Rejoice with me; I have found my lost sheep.’ I tell you that in the same way there will be more rejoicing in heaven over one sinner who repents than over ninety-nine righteous persons who do not need to repent.”*

INTRO: In our society everything is based on number; how much money a person has, how high or low the stock market is the gross sales of

a company, the population of a city, and on and on I could go!

This group mentality has even found its way into the Church. (Mega church vs. small church – Nothing wrong with small church as long as we do not accept our smallness, as long as there is an empty chair – Small thinkers make big stinkers – We cannot accept our bigness as long as there is an empty chair – An empty chair means someone is still out of fellowship with God and His church – We must take personal responsibility for the empty chair – We cannot rest as long as ONE MORE needs to be reached)

(I think in numbers – I used to try to add my mom's grocery bill up and add the tax in my head before the cashier could get it rung up _ I count everything – I am CDO – I can't be OCD because that is not in alphabetical order)

The question must be asked, is God at all interested in our facts and figures? Is He interested in our numbers? Yes! Several times in the Bible people were commanded by God to number various things!

- The woman counted her coins...
- The fisherman counted his fish...
- The king counted his troops...
- The farmer counted his crop...
- The builder counted the cost...

Are you okay with an empty chair next to you when you have friends and relatives that do not regard God, nor value His church? We must prioritize going after ONE MORE in our Life Groups and Sunday services!

God deemed numbers so important that He named a book in His Bible Numbers. While numbers are important to God and important in the Bible, at other times certain people were commanded not to count. David got in serious

trouble with God for counting the people.
(70,000 men died by the plague of the Lord)

While all of these things are important, our scripture text makes us aware that nothing is more important than ONE MORE.

While God values an individual as His most valuable creation this world's system devalues the worth of an individual. The United States and Japan conducted a study to determine the value of the human body:

- 65% oxygen...
- 18% carbon
- 10% hydrogen...
- 3% nitrogen...
- 1.5% calcium...
- 1% phosphorus...
- .05% magnesium...
- .035% potassium...
- .025% sulfur...
- .015% sodium

- .015% chlorine...
- .0004% iron...
- .00004% iodine...
- Fourteen to eighteen square feet of skin...

Total value? \$4.50 - \$5.00! Maybe this explains why abortion is so accepted.

According to this worlds system an individual is not worth much but according to God there is nothing more valuable than a person!

As a Church, we must reach a point where the importance of ONE MORE is non-negotiable! We must guard against an “*easy come, easy go,*” attitude with regard to individuals. ONE MORE must become the priority!

Rev. 3:20 “***Here I am! I stand at the door and knock. If anyone hears my voice and opens the door, I will come in and eat with him, and he with me.***”

The salvation of the individual drove the entire redemptive plan; nothing else has ever taken priority! ***“Go into all the world and preach the Gospel to every creature.”*** (Changing of the Guard – *“Orders Remain Unchanged!”*)

Jesus’ teachings communicate the tremendous value of ONE MORE, but his life and ministry made this truth even clearer:

- Zacchaeus...
- The Samaritan woman...
- Legion... (We are so group oriented that we focus more on how many devils were cast out – and how many pigs committed suicide - than the fact that at the end of the day, this man sat at the feet of Jesus clothed and in his right mind.)
- The thief on the cross...

Notice our text, Luke 15:1-7 ***“Now the tax collectors and “sinners” were all gathering around to hear him. But the Pharisees and the teachers of the law muttered, “This man***

welcomes sinners and eats with them.” Then Jesus told them this parable: “Suppose one of you has a hundred sheep and loses one of them. Does he not leave the ninety-nine in the open country and go after the lost sheep until he finds it? And when he finds it, he joyfully puts it on his shoulders and goes home. Then he says, ‘Rejoice with me; I have found my lost sheep.’ I tell you that in the same way there will be more rejoicing in heaven over one sinner who repents than over ninety-nine righteous persons who do not need to repent.”

Notice four very important things here:

- The shepherd who owns 100 sheep has lost one! (Probably not the first offense)
- The drastic measures to find one lone sheep! *“He leaves 99 in the open country and searches until he finds the one lost sheep!”* (Two legs & a piece of ear... Take it to the sale barn... Shear it whether needed or not... No sale barn or lamb chops...) 2 Peter 3:9 *“The Lord is not slow in keeping*

his promise, as some understand slowness. He is patient with you, not wanting anyone to perish, but everyone to come to repentance.” Rev. 3:20 “Here I am! I stand at the door and knock. If anyone hears my voice and opens the door, I will come in and eat with him, and he with me.” ONE MORE is everything to God – Is it everything to us?

- The celebration! He puts it on his shoulders; he brings it home; he calls his friends and neighbors together and invites them to participate in the homecoming celebration! The good shepherd celebrated ONE MORE – What are we willing to do for ONE MORE?
- The most astounding thing about all of this is the words of Jesus in verse 7, “*I tell you that in the same way there will be more rejoicing in heaven over one sinner who repents than over ninety-nine righteous persons who do not need to repent.*”

Can anyone determine the value of ONE MORE? As a church, we need to refocus on the value of ONE MORE!

(Offer challenge to each person to focus on one un-churched person within driving distance of CT Church – Get them into a Life Group and Sunday services this fall – To do this, we must personally commit to faithfulness to Life Groups and Church Services)

THE LOST COIN

Luke 15:8-10 “Or what woman, having ten silver coins, if she loses one coin, does not light a lamp, sweep the house, and search carefully until she finds it? 9 And when she has found it, she calls her friends and neighbors together, saying, ‘Rejoice with me, for I have found the piece which I lost!’ 10 Likewise, I say to you, there is joy in the presence of the angels of God over one sinner who repents.”

Last week we started talking about ONE MORE, and specifically the parable of the lost sheep.

In this passage Jesus continues driving home His point by using the analogy of a woman sweeping her house to find ONE COIN.

First of all, Jesus' Jewish audience did not respect women as they are respected today. In the story of the miracle of the loaves and fish the scripture say's, "***Five thousand men, plus their women and children.***" Women were treated with a little more respect than a child, but not much more. Jesus brings into view something that was considered inferior, to transmit the truth of the value of ONE MORE!

This parable teaches us about:

- The silver coin... A drachma – Equal in value to the Roman denarius – One day's wage for a Roman soldier. The lady of the

house had ten silver coins and she misplaced one – Is this really a big deal? After all, it is just one coin! Isn't it? Doesn't she have nine more? Yes! Even though she has nine more coins the lady refuses to give up on the ONE MORE principle! How committed are we to the ONE MORE principle? Is it ok with you if 99 people in your family go to Heaven and only one goes to hell? Is it ok with you if only one of your friends goes to hell? Is it ok with you if just 10% of this community remains unchurched? Is it ok with you if the seat next to you remains vacant for the rest of this year? That seat represents someone who is lost – Unchurched - Or de-churched! We MUST become more devoted to the ONE MORE principle than to an easy come, easy go mentality! Becoming more devoted to the ONE MORE principle is to take personal ownership to get ONE MORE into

a life group and church service this year!

Who have you committed to influence through the ONE MORE effort?

- The lamp... This lady knew she was not going to recover her coin in the dark! Could it be that we have accepted the lost-ness of our families? The lost-ness of our friends? The lost-ness of those in our workplaces? The lost-ness of our community? (The McCamey's used to sing a song called "*Getting used to the dark.*") We can never rescue the ONE MORE from the dark by allowing the darkness to continue! Turn the lights on saints, we are searching for ONE MORE! (Braden telling me to turn the light on) Let me remind us, "***We are the light of the world – a city set on a hill that cannot be hidden.***"
- The intentionality of the search... The loss of one coin stirred this lady to action! What

will it take to stir us to action for ONE MORE? This lady took her broom and swept the entire house in search of ONE MORE coin! (I WILL START SWEEPING HERE WHILE I PREACH – MY SERMON NOTES WILL NEED TO BE ON THE SCREEN DOWN FRONT FOR THE REST OF THE SERMON) (I NEED 12 PEOPLE BACKSTAGE WITH BROOMS – AFTER I HAVE BEEN SWEEPING ABOUT 1 MINUTE THE PEOPLE FROM BACKSTAGE WILL COME OUT ONE AT A TIME AND START SWEEPING ON THE STAGE – SPACE THE ENTRANCE OF THE BACKSTAGE PEOPLE ABOUT 10 SECONDS APART AND HAVE THEM COME OUT ALTERNATING SIDES ONE AT A TIME) (I NEED ABOUT 100 BROOMS BACKSTAGE – WHILE THE GUYS ARE ENTERING THE STAGE

HAVE SOMEONE TO BRING 50
BROOMS FROM BACKSTAGE AND
SPREAD THE BROOMS OUT ON THE
FLOOR LEVEL IN FRONT OF THE
STAGE – HAVE SEVERAL PEOPLE
FROM THE AUDIENCE READY TO
COME UP AND RANDOMLY TAKE A
BROOM AND START SWEEPING ALL
OVER THE SANCTUARY) (As I sweep I
will talk about the value of the LOST coin)
This lady was serious about ONE MORE!
Are we serious about ONE MORE? How
serious are we? Are we serious enough to
attend a life group and church service
faithfully so that we can be effective in
reaching ONE MORE? (SWEEPERS KEEP
SWEEPING UNTIL I START TALKING
ABOUT THE COIN BEING FOUND)

- The true value of the coin... This coin was worth one day's wages for a Roman soldier!

This doesn't sound like much as you read the story but let me ask each of you, if you misplaced one day's pay, how much time and effort would you go to, in order to find a day's wages? Would you look for it? Would you enlist the help of others to find it? (I recently left my phone at the ticketing counter in the Memphis airport and didn't realize it until I got through security)

Reaching ONE MORE in a city of six million may seem insignificant but each LOST person is of ultimate importance to God, and MUST become more valuable to us! The object of the ONE MORE principle is: All who are not saved are LOST! LOST! Did you get that? They are LOST! They must be FOUND!

- The passion of the celebration... Luke 15:9-10 ***“And when she has found it, she calls her friends and neighbors together, saying,***

‘Rejoice with me, for I have found the piece which I lost!’ 10 Likewise, I say to you, there is joy in the presence of the angels of God over one sinner who repents.”

(HAVE A LADY WHO CAN PLAY THE PART, TO FIND A QUARTER UNDER MY CHAIR – SHE NEEDS TO BE WEARING A MIC – THE MIC NEEDS TO BE ON – WHEN I FINISH READING THIS SCRIPTURE SHE NEEDS TO INSTANTLY FIND THE COIN AND START RUNNING ALL OVER THE BUILDING SHOUTING THAT SHE HAS FOUND THE COIN – HAVE ALL SWEEPERS TO START CELEBRATING AND SHOUTING AS WELL – CONGRATULATING THE LADY AND EACH OTHER)

God places tremendous value on the human soul. Matthew 18:10

“Take heed that you do not despise one of

these little ones, for I say to you that in heaven their angels always see the face of My Father who is in heaven. This scripture is letting us know that, how a person is treated here on earth, brings a facial reaction and a response from the face of the Father! – The reason there is extreme rejoicing among the angels, over a sinner's repentance is because it brings a visible change in the countenance of God! - The God of the universe - The Creator and Sustainer of all life – The one who spoke galaxies into existence – The one who measured out the heavens with the span of His hand – The one who traced out courses for the rivers with His fingers and hollowed out the seas with the palm of His hand – The one who raised up the hills and mountains with His spoken word - Personally reacts when **ONE MORE** enters into renewed relationship with Him!!!

There is “*More rejoicing in Heaven for one sinner who repents than over 99 righteous people who do not need to repent.*” Don’t you think the church should have party time - every time - someone makes Jesus the Lord of their life?

(HAVE THE PEOPLE WHO HAVE BEEN SWEEPING TO GO BACK TO THEIR SEATS)

CONCLUSION:

Talk about the holiday’s or a family reunion when someone is missing from the celebration)

The empty seat beside you represents the absence of one of God’s precious children from the Father’s house! “*He is not willing that ANYONE should perish, but that EVERYONE would come to repentance.*”

We are creating a culture of invitation with this ONE MORE series! CT Church will have an ANYONE and EVERYONE attitude! Because of the ONE MORE attitude, CT Church is about to have the most explosive season of growth in its storied history! The past is great – The future is glorious!

The sign on Malvern High School stated *“It’s here for the taking!”* That slogan grips me to this very day! (Story of knocking doors in this community – A lady answered the door and said *“I was kneeling at my couch, rededicating my life to Christ when you knocked on the door! I had just prayed and asked the Lord where He would like me to go to church!”*)

Do we want to experience revival of biblical proportions in CT Church? If so, we must move into a season where absolutely nothing, is going to stir the heart, move the hand, and stimulate the passion of this church, like the assignment of ONE MORE!

(GIVE EACH FAMILY A BROOM TO
REMINDE THEM OF THEIR ASSIGNMENT
OF REACHING ONE MORE)

THE LOST SON

Luke 15:11-32 *“Then He said: “A certain man had two sons. 12 And the younger of them said to his father, ‘Father, give me the portion of goods that falls to me.’ So he divided to them his livelihood. 13 And not many days after, the younger son gathered all together, journeyed to a far country, and there wasted his possessions with prodigal living.”*

Today marks the third and final message in our ONE MORE series.

In this passage of Scripture, in order to make His point, Jesus puts forth three parables:

- The lost sheep...
- The lost coin...
- The lost son...

Wait a minute! The lost son? In this particular parable Jesus attempts to put real flesh and blood on what He was attempting to teach the His Jewish audience. (Mostly Pharisees and teachers of the Law)

These religious snobs, in their self-righteous arrogance, devalued and despised those they deemed lesser than themselves. (They hated the Samaritans – They were bigots of the worst kind)

Jesus confronted them directly and forcefully. He revealed the heart of the Father with regard to ALL persons! This group of up and out lawmakers - and law-keepers - valued religious systems and protocols but devalued the importance of individuals. This is not too unlike the modern church world! Religious leaders are constantly looking to play to the up-and-outers and devalue the down-and-outers! (Pastor who told me he spends 50% of his time with the top 10% of his givers)

Through these parables Jesus was attempting to communicate, that this gospel is to:

- The haves and have nots...
- The anyone's and everyone's...
- The moral and the immoral...
- The righteous and the unrighteous...
- The down-and outers and the up-and-outers...
- The whosoever will's and the whosoever wont's...

Hear me today – He didn't die for some! He died for all!

Jesus went from talking about an animal – To talking about an inanimate object – To talking about a human being! As misguided as the prodigal son may have been, he was still the son of a father, and as such, the object of a father's love!

The younger son of the father:

- Made an unusual request... Traditionally the inheritance would be distributed at the death of the father – It was not yet his to ask for - This request by the younger son was a premature request – When we attempt to get promoted prematurely we are out of alignment – This request was disrespectful - Because this son was out of order he was therefore out of the path of blessing and favor - Many of you know someone right now who is out of alignment with their marriage – Their family – Their career – Their church – Their pastor - Their God – Guess what? They are ONE MORE! Go after them!
- Wasted the inheritance of the father... The inheritance never belonged to him – EVER! It was not the sons to demand, it was the fathers to give, at the appropriate time! He had friends as long as he had money - The friends and the money always run out at the same time! Do you know someone who has wasted their resources and life, and appear

to have nothing left? That person is a ONE MORE! Go after them!

- Became a citizen of a foreign country... this guy was out of control – He wasted everything! Everything! Rather than doing the right thing and returning home he attempted to DO IT HIS WAY! When we are in a bad place, our way is almost always the wrong way! Here is where someone from CT Church would come in handy! Put an arm around the kid and say, “*Don’t you think it would be better to go back to the father’s house?*” Do you know people who have wasted everything, yet, they keep making poor decisions? They are ONE MORE! Go after them!
- Found employment... He believed he could work his way out of the situation! He worked feeding pigs! Nothing could be lower to a Hebrew than feeding pigs! Multitudes of people, that we all know, are trying to work their way into a better place! (We are not saved by works – “*Come now*

and let us reason together... “***For by grace are you saved through faith...***” The cross + nothing = Salvation) Do you know someone who is trying to work their way out of a bad situation? They are ONE MORE! Go after them! This is as bad as it gets – Or is it?

- Became very hungry... This young man who once had it all – Is in a foreign country – Has given up his citizenship – Is working feeding pigs – The Bible says he is sooooo hungry that he wanted to eat the husks from the corn that he was feeding to the pigs – ***“But no man would allow it...”*** There is nothing in this world but emptiness! How many people do you know in this situation? They are ONE MORE! Go after them!
- Came to himself... This is where the story turns wonderful! This kid finally got enough wits about him to say, ***“I will return to my father and ask to become a hired servant – My father treats his lowliest servant better than this!”*** Who do you know who has hit

rock bottom? Could it be that they are waiting for someone to extend an invitation to come home? Could it be that God has placed you in their life, strategically, for this purpose? They are the ONE MORE, and that someone is you! Go after them!

CONCLUSION:

Let me shout it to THE ONE this morning,
COME HOME!!! Let me shout it to all CT'ers –
Go after the ONE MORE!

Listen to some of the most beautiful words in scripture! *“And while he was yet a great way off, his father ran and fell on his neck and kissed him.”*

Look with me at the actions of the father:

- He was waiting for the son... Every day he was waiting! The father is waiting for ONE MORE! Every day He is waiting for ONE MORE! Today He is waiting for ONE MORE!

- He fell on his neck and kissed him... The father didn't care who saw his public display of affection! The Father is waiting for ONE MORE to make a move! He doesn't care who notices or sees! The Pharisees said “*He eats with sinners!*” So? So what? No matter where the ONE MORE has been, or who they have been with, the Father is not afraid to be seen with ONE MORE!
- He ordered a bath and a robe... The Father stands ready to wash the road of this world from ONE MORE! The robe was the father's robe! When this son dawned that robe it spoke to that Jewish audience that this boy WOULD NOT be a servant, he would be a son! RESET! The Father stands ready to do a RESET in the life of ONE MORE – the question is whether we will be a part of it? (Or will we react with the attitude of the elder church member – I mean son?)
- He ordered the fatted calf to be killed... The father threw a party because the lost son was

home! The fatted calf tells me the father had been preparing for the son's arrival! (Old Song - *"All things are ready – Come to the feast! Come while the table now is spread! Hear the invitation – Come whosoever will! Praise God for full salvation, come whosoever will."*) Can you hear the sound of the party? The party is not for the son who stayed home (That will come later), it is for the ONE MORE! CT, get ready to party! We are going to focus on going after the ONE MORE and it is going to be party time at the church! Don't be an elder church member, I mean, son! There are more fatted calves and plenty of time to party! Your time will come – Don't become impatient!

- He gave the lost son a ring... This is significant because the ring is how the Father signed all important documents! Did this father lose his mind? The welcome I can understand – The kiss I can comprehend – The bath and robe I can grasp – The fatted calf I get – But to give such an irresponsible

son the signature of the family fortune is another thing! The ONE MORE doesn't have to earn their way in, or back in! There is no seniority in Kingdom life! You are either in, or not in! You are either a part of it, or not a part of it! You are either a son, or you are not a son! Please tell the ONE MORE that they don't have to make up their previous mistakes to God, or the church – They can come just as they are! We catch em' – God cleans em'! The thief on the cross – The guy who hired people at daybreak – At noon – And the middle of the afternoon – The resources are the Father's to distribute – to anyone – to everyone - the way He chooses! He chooses THE ONE and so do we!